

GEORGE WASHINGTON • SEPTEMBER 19, 1796

The Farewell Address

Observe good faith and justice towards all nations; cultivate peace and harmony with all. Religion and morality enjoin this conduct; and can it be that good policy does not equally enjoin it? It will be worthy of a free, enlightened, and at no distant period, a great nation, to give to mankind the magnanimous and too novel example of a people always guided by an exalted justice and benevolence.

It is our true policy to

steer clear of
permanent alliances

with any portion of the foreign world; so far, I mean, as we are now at liberty to do it.

United States • 19th September, 1796 • G. Washington